



Stray shifted to summer 2022

Cyberpunk cat simulator Stray, where one can play third-person as a cat, delayed to summer of 2022. <https://digit.in/may22-48>



Loopity Loop

Elon Musk's The Boring Company ready to start testing Hyperloop at full capacity this year. <https://digit.in/may22-49>

ASUS ROG Fusion II 500

ASUS' best gaming headset yet?

The ASUS ROG Fusion II 500 looks like a pretty minimalist gaming headset that doesn't stand out too much, but we've got a BOATLOAD of features inside these cans – and a price tag to match.

BUILD AND DESIGN

At a glance, these are a very unassuming pair of headphones, save for the ROG logo on either cup. That is, until you plug the headphones in and the RGB LED stripes kick in. They are, however, behind the cans, so if you're a streamer or facing a camera, nobody is going to be able to see them. Other than that, the Fusion II 500 sports a very premium, lightweight build with good quality plastic that doesn't feel cheap to touch. The faux leather headband is super comfortable on your head, and there's a metal band on the inside, which if you look closely, sports a neat ROG design. It's in line with the whole minimalistic thing the headset has going on. This makes the RGB LED stripes stand out even more on the headset's build.

For the ear pads, you've got two options. Two leatherette pads which are on the headset by default, and two extra pads with breathable fabric.

FEATURES

These headphones are packed with features. Starting with the on-ear controls, we've got some on both cups so let's start with the left. There's a textured mic mute switch, under which you have the volume dial. The volume dial also doubles as the 7.1 surround sound switch, which you can turn on or off by pushing down on the volume dial. On the right cup, we've got a PC/console mode switch, under which you have a game chat volume control dial. This basically allows you to balance in-game



BUILD AND DESIGN...	79
FEATURES.....	75
PERFORMANCE.....	87
VALUE.....	23



Price
₹22,999

audio and chat audio. Say you're on a Discord call, and something important comes up in-game, turn up

the game volume while pushing chat to the background. Just do the opposite if the game volume is too loud and you can't hear your friends.

For connectivity options, you've got USB-A, USB-C, and a 3.5mm headphone jack. The cables provided are type-C to type-C and a 3.5mm to 3.5mm aux cable. A type-C to type-A adapter is included in the box.

PERFORMANCE

When it comes to audio performance, the ASUS ROG Fusion II 500 has great neutral and dynamic sound. Furthermore, you've got a customisable EQ via ASUS's ARMOURY CRATE software. The audio is powered by 50mm neodymium drivers and the headset comes with ESS 9280 Quad DAC – four Digital-Analogue Converters (DACs), each assigned to its own frequency band, and airtight driver chambers.

The headset also has great virtual 7.1 surround-sound implementation, so naturally, these are great for FPS games, or games where spatial awareness is required. Coming to the mic, the Fusion II 500 doesn't have a boom mic,

and instead has a beamforming microphone. While we're usually not fans of beamforming microphones, the Fusion II 500 has the best implementation of a beamforming mic we've seen yet on a gaming headphone. Furthermore, it's paired with ASUS's AI-based noise cancellation which actually works pretty well and does a decent job of cutting down background noise and even voices to an extent.

Unfortunately, while this is technically a cross-platform headset and works with all mainstream consoles and handhelds, most of its features are limited to PC. This includes the AI-based noise cancellation on the mic as well, as the software only works on PC.

BOTTOMLINE

The ASUS ROG Fusion II 500 is a pretty awesome pair of gaming headphones, but are they worth an asking price of ₹22,999? The Fusion II 500 comes with great sound performance, hi-res audio support, customisable EQ, a great beamforming microphone with AI noise cancelling, and more. If you're looking for a pair of cans with ALL of that, then you might want to consider shelling out that much money. However, you can certainly more than make do with a lot of the cheaper options in the market such as the Razer BlackShark V2, the Hyperx Cloud Alpha Pro, or the ASUS ROG Delta S.

—Manish Rajesh

SPECIFICATIONS

CONNECTOR: USB-A | USB-C | 3.5mm | SUPPORTED PLATFORMS: PC | MAC | PlayStation 4 | PlayStation 5 | Nintendo Switch | Xbox one | Xbox Series X | Xbox Series S | iPad | DRIVER MATERIAL: Neodymium magnet | DRIVER SIZE: 50mm | HEADPHONES IMPEDANCE: 32 Ohm | HEADPHONES FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20 ~ 40000 Hz | MICROPHONE PICK-UP PATTERN: Omnidirectional | MICROPHONE SENSITIVITY: -37 dB | MICROPHONE FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 100 ~ 10000 Hz | AI Noise Cancelling Microphone | HI-FI DAC: ESS 9280 | HI-FI AMP: ESS 9280 | CHANNEL: Virtual 7.1 | WEIGHT: 310 g | USB-C CABLE: 1.5m; 3.5 mm cable: 1.5m

CONTACT

ASUS | PHONE: 1800-2090365 | EMAIL: Web form | WEBSITE: <https://www.asus.com/in/>